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WHY AUSTRALIAN ODDS ON US SPORTS LAG THE AMERICAN MARKET

ODDS ACE AUSTRALIA · INFORMATION, NOT ADVICE · 18+ · PUBLISHED 6 OCTOBER 2026 · UPDATED 8 OCTOBER 2026

If you follow NFL, NBA, NHL or MLB prices at an Australian bookmaker, you'll have seen it: the US market moves, and for a while the Aussie price stays where it was. In our tracking so far, an alerted price has typically lasted a few hours, and it varies a lot from one price to the next. This page explains why that happens, what it looks like, and how we measure it.

The short version

Far more money is bet on American sports in America than in Australia. When something changes, say a quarterback is ruled out two hours before kick-off, or the weather turns in Green Bay, the big US sportsbooks and the betting exchanges move within seconds, because that's where the sharpest money is and where the most bets are. Australian bookmakers mostly take their lead from that market rather than setting their own US-sports prices from scratch. They catch up, but the catching up takes time, and in that window an Aussie price can still show the old line.

Why the gap exists at all

- **Volume.** US sports are a small part of an Australian bookmaker's turnover, well behind racing, AFL and NRL. A trader in Australia isn't watching every NHL prop market the way a US book has to.
- **Time zones.** Most US games are played between about 2am and 2pm Sydney time. Australian trading desks are at their thinnest exactly when the American market is at its busiest.
- **Feeds and manual checks.** Many Australian prices on US sports come from a data feed with a trader checking on top. A feed updates on a schedule; a trader updates when they get to it.
- **Quick to shorten, slow to lengthen.** Bookmakers are quick to shorten a price that's attracting money and slower to lengthen one that isn't. A price that has become too *long* compared with the US market can sit for a while, because nobody is forcing the issue.

What the lag looks like

An alert from Odds Ace records three things: the Aussie price, the US reference price at the same moment (the US market's price with the bookmakers' margin removed), and the gap between them. For example: an Australian bookmaker offers 1.80 on a player prop while the US reference price is 1.65. That's a gap of +9.1% (1.80 ÷ 1.65 − 1). A gap is a price difference, not a profit: prices move fast, the Aussie price may be gone by the time you look, and a bet at any price can still lose.

Every alert we've sent since launch is in the results on our home page, which update every hour. Every alert is settled from the box score after the game and published, wins and losses alike, in our free Telegram channel, t.me/oddsaceresults.

How long an alerted price lasts

This is the figure that matters, and it's the one we track most carefully. After each alert, we keep re-checking the same bookmaker's price until the game starts, so we can say how long the alerted price lasted and whether it had moved by kick-off. Those timings are on the home page ("How the alerted prices held up") and update every hour, and every Wednesday a price-lag post in our free Telegram channel gives the past week's

figures: how many alerts went out in each sport, how many of the alerted prices had moved toward the US price by kick-off, and the typical time an alerted price lasted.

What moves the US market first

- **Injury and lineup news.** The biggest driver in the NFL and NBA. Inactives lists, late scratches, a starting goalie announced in the NHL.
- **Weather.** Wind and rain change totals in the NFL and MLB. Odds Ace flags weather at outdoor stadiums for that reason.
- **Sharp money.** Professional bettors in the US move lines by betting into them. Australian prices follow that movement rather than cause it.
- **Market consensus.** When several large US books move together, that's the market's new price. A lone move at one book usually isn't.

Where Odds Ace fits

Odds Ace checks 7 Australian-licensed bookmakers against 8 major US sportsbooks 24 hours a day and sends a Telegram alert when an Aussie price is out of line with the US market. It is an information service: no predictions, no "sure things" and no bookmaker affiliation. The whole record is public. Members get the alerts live; details and pricing are on the home page.

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